

Haiti

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** May 18, 1803 **Usage:** National and Civil

For official and state purposes the flag is charged with the national arms on a central white rectangle



Blue and red are taken from the French *Tricolore*

North America



Haiti became a French colony in 1697, but in 1803 a rebellion broke out. Independence was granted on January 1, 1804.

The blue and red of the flag were retained after a French *Tricolore* was torn up by the rebel Jean-Jacques Dessalines in 1803. The two parts were stitched together horizontally to make a new flag.

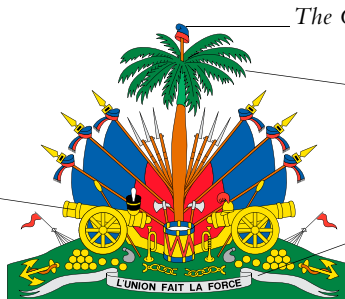
However a rival flag of vertical black and red panels was also used at various times, most recently in the

period from 1964–86, during the regime of the Duvalier family.

Since 1843 the flag for official and state use has had the arms on a white panel in the center. The coat of arms depicts a trophy of weapons ready to defend freedom, and a royal palm topped with a Cap of Liberty for the country's independence.

ARMS OF HAITI

Weapons reflect the people's willingness to defend their liberty



The Cap of Liberty

The royal palm symbolizes independence

The national motto—"L'Union Fait La Force" meaning "Union is Strength"